Intermediate (swap in a structured parser) — Hints

> Back to the exercise · Hint 1 · Hint 2 · Solution

Only 2 hints — work through them in order, and don't jump ahead until you've genuinely tried. Each hint builds toward the full solution.

- Hint 1 — The idea, and the exact pieces
- Hint 2 — The plan, and almost the whole thing

Hint 1 — The idea, and the exact pieces

`.with_structured_output(Person)` returns a new runnable whose output is already a `Person`, not text. With `gpt-4o-mini` it uses the same constrained decoding as Doc04's `.parse()` — the "shape during" method from the Output parsers topic.

That means a text with no person in it does **not** raise an error: the model **must** fill the form, so with `name: str` and `age: int` it invents something (`''` and `0`, for example). The fix is Doc04's rule again — `str | None` and `int | None` — so "nothing found" becomes a real answer.

A `ValidationError` is still possible (the reply fails the model in a rare case), so catch it by name.

Hint 2 — The plan, and almost the whole thing

```
class Person: name: str | None, age: int | None

function extract_person(text) -> Person | None:
    try: person = structured_model.invoke(text)
    except ValidationError: return None
    if name is None and age is None: return None
    return person
```

This is the same shape as Doc04's `extract_info()` — only the call changed from `client.beta.chat.completions.parse(...)` to `.invoke(...)`. Write it, run it on both texts, then compare against the Solution.

Full solution: Show me the solution